E17, Walthamstow, London

This El Niño probably won't freeze E17. It reaches the borough twice. This winter it comes as flu and cold homes among housebound older people, in ordinary cold weeks and short cold spells. Next summer it comes as food prices, forecast to peak around July 2027, when every winter scheme has closed. The most lives are saved by getting vaccines, money, and warmth to frail people living alone before December, and by having whoever already knocks on their door check that they are eating. The council should also keep part of its crisis fund for 2027.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
The Climate Impact Lab region containing the London Borough of Waltham Forest (about 278,000 people, roughly one region; region name not resolved). E17 is the borough's central and western part	No figure published for the UK or Europe	Jun 2026 – Feb 2027 (heat only; not this hazard)	Flu and cold homes in ordinary cold weeks; short cold spells; power loss; a food-price rise in 2027; surface-water flooding (mainly a summer hazard)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



51.58°N 0.03°W, United Kingdom · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Flu and cold homes among housebound older people are this winter's risk, and food prices, forecast to peak around July 2027, arrive when every winter scheme has closed.
- **First action.** NHS North East London, Waltham Forest primary care networks, and pharmacies run a vaccination catch-up now, with housebound visits by mid-November and the catch-up done by early December.*
- **The money.** £45k floor, £80k target (£60k if no credit route by 30 November), £100k ceiling; the money pays for a referral, a credit to the energy account, and a knock that checks for heat and food.
- **Do not.** Do not make referral-only food parcels the default winter response, or count parcels as success.

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

27/27 recommendations checked. 2 confirmed, 14 corrected (partially confirmed), 2 unverified, and 9 contraindicated. Two proposed funding placements were also contraindicated and dropped. **This revision replaces the 10 October briefing.** It adds an eighth lens, on food supply chains, and re-verifies the first version. **What changed:**

- The vaccination catch-up stays first but is retargeted at housebound people over 75 and RSV. The best UK study, which uses England's age-65 eligibility cutoff, found no measurable fall in deaths when flu-vaccine uptake jumped at 65.
- HEET cannot pay fuel credit, so the £200 credit now goes through Citizens Advice.
- The Warm Home Discount's qualifying date for this winter (23 August) has passed.
- The food actions are new.

The funding target is £80k, against £75k in the first version, a 7% rise. **The El Niño premise was tested, not assumed,** in the first version, from 43 winters of Hampstead records and 52 of Heathrow temperatures; it is carried forward unchanged. **Exposure figure:** Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review, publishes none for the UK. Every local mortality figure below is borough-level, not E17.

DOES EL NIÑO MATTER HERE? THE PREMISE, TESTED

Hampstead daily records, winters 1973–74 to 2015–16 (the record ends in July 2016), classed by the December–February Oceanic Niño Index. Heathrow's complete temperature record to 2024–25 was used as a cross-check. Only four or five winters were strong El Niños, so read every difference as a tilt, not a rule.

WINTERS	DEC–FEB MEAN (°C)	NIGHTS AT OR BELOW −3 °C, DEC–MAR	JAN–MAR DAYS WITH MEAN AT OR BELOW 0 °C	WINTERS WITH A 7-DAY RUN AT OR BELOW 0 °C	WINTERS WITH A 3-DAY RUN AT OR BELOW 2 °C	OCT–FEB RAIN (MM)
Strong El Niño (4)	5.6	3.3	2.0	0 of 4	3 of 4	281
Moderate or weak El Niño (11)	4.7	6.2	4.6	3 of 11	10 of 11	397

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WINTERS	DEC–FEB MEAN (°C)	NIGHTS AT OR BELOW −3 °C, DEC–MAR	JAN–MAR DAYS WITH MEAN AT OR BELOW 0 °C	WINTERS WITH A 7-DAY RUN AT OR BELOW 0 °C	WINTERS WITH A 3-DAY RUN AT OR BELOW 2 °C	OCT–FEB RAIN (MM)
Neutral (13)	4.4	8.9	7.3	6 of 13	11 of 13	358
La Niña (15)	5.0	6.1	4.5	2 of 15	11 of 15	284

- **Strong El Niño winters here have been mild.** They were the warmest class and had the fewest frosts. None produced a 7-day freeze, which is the run that triggers the government's Cold Weather Payment. 2015–16, the last very strong event, averaged 7.2 °C with no hard frosts. Heathrow tells the same story: 6.6 °C in strong winters, against 5.4 °C in neutral ones.
- **Short cold spells still came.** Three of the four strong winters had a spell of three days at or below 2 °C. That is about where cold harms health, so plan for short cold spells, not for a deep freeze.
- **The counter-example is 2009–10.** Its index sat at 1.47, just under the strong threshold. It averaged 2.6 °C, with 15 hard-frost nights and a 7-day freeze, so nobody should plan on a mild winter either.
- **Rain shows no consistent tilt.** Moderate El Niño winters were the wettest class, but strong ones were not: 1991–92 was dry, and 2023–24 was wet at Heathrow.
- **What the Met Office says.** *"For the UK, El Niño increases the chances of a wetter and stormier late autumn and early winter period, which would also likely be milder than normal."* Later in winter there is *"an increased chance of Sudden Stratospheric Warming (SSW) events… increasing the potential for cold weather,"* and El Niño *"alone does not determine precise weather patterns"* (Met Office blog, 23 September 2026).

EXPOSURE, HONESTLY

WHO DIES, AND WHAT FLOODS

- **A young borough with an under-protected older minority.** Waltham Forest's median age is 35, against 40 for England. 10.1% of residents are 65 or over and 4.4% are 75 or over. 8,254 households are one person aged 66 or over living alone, 8.0% of all households (Census 2021).
- **Vaccine uptake is low and falling.** Flu vaccination among over-65s has fallen every year: 68.5% (2020/21), 65.8%, 64.8%, 62.0%, and 56.7% in 2024/25, against 74.9% for England. GP-list inflation may understate the true figure somewhat. This is the borough's largest reachable gap.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Most cold deaths come in ordinary cold weeks, not in cold snaps.** Globally, cold accounts for 7.29% of deaths and extreme temperatures only 0.86% (Gasparrini 2015). No excess-winter-death figure exists for E17. The borough's 2020-21 index (65.5%) was driven by COVID, is not age-standardised, and should not be used as a baseline.
- **Fuel poverty is above London's rate.** 12.2% of households (13,631) were fuel poor in 2023, against 9.3% for London and 11.4% for England (DESNZ modelled figures). About 17% of cold deaths among people over 75 in England are attributable to fuel poverty (Wan 2026, an ecological study).
- **Many people sit outside the usual reach.** 27.8% of homes are privately rented. 1,527 households were in temporary accommodation in April 2026, and 47% of them were placed outside the borough. Romanian is the largest language after English (10,600 speakers), followed by Urdu, Bulgarian, Polish, and Turkish. 22% of residents do not have English as their main language.
- **Floods recur on the same streets, and they come in summer.** The 25 July 2021 cloudburst was about a 1-in-170-year event, against sewers built for 1-in-30. It flooded 224 properties and 28 school sites. Whipps Cross Hospital lost 168 beds and 582 operations, and 46 households at St David's Court were displaced by power loss. It flooded again on 17 August 2022. No one died in either flood. Winter rain arrives with longer warnings and lower intensity.

HOW FOOD REACHES E17 SUPPLY CHAIN

New in this revision. The honest finding is that El Niño's food signal for London is real but weak and late, and it arrives mixed with bigger shocks.

- **London will not run short of food; the risk is price.** The UK produced about 60% of its food in 2025, down from 65%, and about 56% of its vegetables, far less in winter (DEFRA, *Agriculture in the UK 2025*, via trade press). About a quarter of UK food imports, roughly £17bn, including rice, coffee, and cocoa, come from the regions most exposed to El Niño (ECIU, September 2026).
- **The El Niño pressure is visible, but it is one cause among several.** FAO's food price index reached 136.0 in September 2026, its highest since late 2022. Sugar rose 6.1% in a month, and FAO named India's monsoon "with strengthening El Niño" as one of four causes. India's rice crop may fall by about 10 million tonnes, but record stocks make an export ban unlikely, and none has been announced. The bigger drivers are the Iran conflict and the disruption to shipping through the Strait of Hormuz since February 2026, Black Sea grain, and European drought.
- **Prices are low now and are forecast to peak next summer.** UK food inflation was 1.3% in August 2026 (ONS). The Food and Drink Federation forecasts 3.9% by December and a peak of 6.4% in July 2027; IGD forecasts 5.6–6.6% for 2027 and rates El Niño a high-severity risk. Shop buffers and supplier hedging delay a shock rather than absorb it.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Shortages come from weather where the food grows.** In February 2023, cold in Spain and floods and cancelled ferries in Morocco emptied salad shelves; supermarkets limited purchases and vegetable prices were 18% higher than a year earlier. That was a La Niña winter, so it shows how such a shock works, not what El Niño will do.
- **History says the basket peaks a year or two after the event.** After the 1972–73 El Niño, Peru's anchovy fishery collapsed, soy prices spiked, and UK food inflation peaked at 28.3% in July 1975. It reached 13.2% in August 2008 and 19.2% in March 2023, the highest since 1977.
- **In E17, food help depends on referrals and on volunteers.** Eat or Heat (Quaker Meeting House, Jewel Road), the borough's largest independent food bank, takes referrals only, and its income fell from £212,676 in 2021 to £118,525 in 2025. No council meals-on-wheels service was found. Age UK Waltham Forest's volunteer shopping service delivers within 2–3 working days for £4 a shop. In July 2022, more than 11,000 residents were regularly using food banks, by a council figure; no later count exists.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED BY LIVES PER EFFORT

The first four actions carry nearly all the expected deaths this winter. Actions 5 to 12 reach the people every list misses and prepare for the 2027 food-price peak. Actions 13 and 14 cover power loss and hospital discharge. The flood actions (15 to 18) are carried from the first version, where they were verified; they protect homes, schools, and power more than lives, and their risk peaks in summer.

1. Run a vaccination catch-up now, led by RSV and home visits for housebound people over 75, then flu for everyone 65 and over, COVID for 75 and over, and vaccination of care-home staff*

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND FOR THE UK

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
NHS North East London ICB; Waltham Forest primary care networks; pharmacies; care-home operators	Housebound visits by mid-November; catch-up by early December	NHS-funded programmes; home-visit capacity to be confirmed	RSV and flu deaths among the oldest, in a season that may peak early

Over-65 flu uptake here was 56.7% in 2024/25, against 74.9% for England, and has fallen every year since 68.5% in 2020/21; even England's most deprived tenth reached 68%. Last season started early and peaked in the first week of December, at 10.8 admissions per 100,000, with 29% vaccine effectiveness against hospitalisation in over-65s. RSV vaccine is about 82% effective against RSV hospitalisation in people aged 75 to 79 (UKHSA), and is offered to everyone 75 and over, at-risk 65 to 74 year olds, and care-home

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

residents. Vaccinating care-home staff reduced residents' all-cause deaths (risk ratio 0.69; Cochrane 2025, moderate certainty). The children's nasal flu programme runs in schools until the end of November, which cuts transmission to grandparents: in Japan, vaccinating schoolchildren was followed by a 36% fall in pneumonia and influenza deaths among older people (Charu et al. 2011, ecological).

Corrections: the effect of flu vaccine on deaths is uncertain. Anderson, Dobkin & Gorry (Annals of Internal Medicine 2020) used England and Wales's age-65 eligibility cutoff: uptake jumped about 23 points at 65, but hospitalisations and deaths did not measurably fall. That study covers people near 65, before adjuvanted vaccines, and says nothing about people over 80 or the housebound, which is why the catch-up now leads with them. The first version's citation for the Japan figure was wrong; it is Charu et al., not Reichert.

2. Get money to frail, fuel-poor older people before December: a Pension Credit claim push through the council's existing drop-ins and Citizens Advice, and GP referrals of fuel-poor over-75s with COPD or heart failure to HEET, with £200 of credit paid to their energy account through Citizens Advice

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
GP practices refer; HEET advises; Citizens Advice Waltham Forest pays credit; council's Waltham Forest Max and Age UK drop-ins for Pension Credit	Referrals from November	£40k HEET and credit; £15k Citizens Advice (see funding)	Cold-home deaths among the oldest and sickest

About 3,300 eligible residents were not claiming Pension Credit in 2024 (council figure). A successful claim unlocks the Winter Fuel Payment (£100–£300 for people born on or before 27 June 1960), the Cold Weather Payment, and council tax support. The Winter Fuel Payment has been credited with about half the fall in excess winter deaths since 1999/2000 (Iparraguirre 2015, an ecological time series by Age UK's chief economist), and a stronger UK study found it lowered a blood marker of cardiovascular risk (Crossley & Zilio 2018) without measuring deaths. HEET is commissioned by the council to deliver the borough's fuel-poverty service and takes health and social-care referrals. Target by illness plus fuel poverty, not by income alone.

Corrections: HEET pays no vouchers or credit, so the £200 goes to the supplier account through Citizens Advice, with HEET referring. The council's March 2026 Pension Credit campaign runs through Waltham Forest Max and Age UK drop-ins; expand those rather than build a new drive. A claim made now will not bring this winter's Warm Home Discount, whose qualifying date was 23 August. The "50% fall in

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

deaths" sometimes quoted for the Winter Fuel Payment overstates the study.

3. On every amber cold-health alert, a named person phones or calls on each housebound older person living alone, checks there is heating and food in the house, books a volunteer shop if not, and registers them with UK Power Networks' Priority Services Register

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH · PHILANTHROPIST · FOOD SUPPLY

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: TORONTO COLD ALERTS, NO EFFECT (A CAUTION)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	TRIGGER
Age UK Waltham Forest, with mutual-aid groups and faith networks; Faizan-E-Islam Masjid's weekend meal drivers for referred neighbours	Lists by 31 October; every amber alert, 1 November to 31 March	£25k coordinator, volunteers, and grocery budget (see funding)	UKHSA amber cold-health alert for London

Age UK Waltham Forest's befriending scheme served 165 people (average age 83, 75% with poor mobility) in May 2025 and has run on donations since the council stopped funding it. Its volunteer shopping service needs 2–3 working days, so book shops when an alert is forecast, not on the day. Faizan-E-Islam Masjid on Lea Bridge Road already collects and delivers hot meals on Saturdays and Sundays; ask it to add housebound neighbours referred by Age UK, and to report a cold home rather than try to fix it. In cold months the poorest older households cut food spending (Beatty, Blow & Crossley 2014), so a heating check without a food check misses half the trade-off.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Evidence is thin. No study shows check-ins reduce cold deaths, and alerts alone do not: Toronto's cold-weather programme found no effect on cardiovascular admissions (risk ratio 0.98, 0.91 to 1.05). The US "More Than a Meal" trial of delivered meals reduced loneliness, with daily delivery doing best; its falls and hospitalisation findings are from an unreviewed pilot report. The knock is the intervention; the alert only times it. Check that the council's replacement "Lifeline" visiting service does not already make these calls.

4. The council uses its Crisis and Resilience Fund to pay energy crisis payments proactively on an amber cold-health alert, pays in cash rather than supermarket vouchers, and plans to spend more in 2027, when food prices peak

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FOOD SUPPLY · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST

ADAPTATION INVENTORY: ANTICIPATORY CASH, MONGOLIA (PRECEDENT OUTSIDE THE UK)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	TRIGGER
Waltham Forest Council, from its DWP Crisis and Resilience Fund grant	Decision by 30 November; 2027 profile agreed with DWP in writing	Reallocation within an existing grant; amount for the council to set	UKHSA amber cold-health alert (winter); ONS food inflation (2027; see action 11)

The Crisis and Resilience Fund replaced the Household Support Fund on 1 April 2026 and runs to March 2029. Its guidance lets crisis payments cover domestic energy, lets councils set local eligibility, and allows proactive payments. Waltham Forest's page lists no energy or pensioner support, no weather trigger, and no allocation. The only automatic cold payment, the Cold Weather Payment, needs a seven-day freeze, which none of London's strong El Niño winters produced. The food-price peak is forecast for July 2027, after every winter scheme closes, so the council should profile its three-year envelope toward 2027 instead of spending it all by March.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the national fund has four strands (crisis payments, housing payments, resilience services, community coordination), so this is a local rule inside the crisis payment strand. The guidance has no explicit rule on carrying money between years, and money left at the end of year 3 can be recovered; confirm the profile with DWP in writing. Holding money back must not close the crisis payment scheme, which councils should keep open all year. The council still pays holiday food support as supermarket vouchers.

5. Widen who can refer people to food help for December to February, write a cash-first leaflet with the council, and hand out a dated, translated card of the no-referral food sessions

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · FOOD SUPPLY · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Eat or Heat and other food banks; Waltham Forest Council with the Independent Food Aid Network (IFAN); Hornbeam, faith leaders, and mutual-aid groups distribute	**Card by 1 November; leaflet by December**	**Volunteer time; translation and print not costed**	**People without a caseworker going without food, and older people who never ask**

The people most at risk are often missing from food banks because they need a referral from a professional they have never met. Eat or Heat's criteria already accept referrals from officers of religious and welfare organisations, so naming trusted volunteers and faith leaders as referrers is cheap. Eighteen London boroughs have an IFAN "Worrying about money?" cash-first leaflet; Waltham Forest does not. The card lists, with times and conditions, the sessions that need no referral (spring 2026 guide): the Solidarity Supermarket at the Hornbeam, 458 Hoe Street (low-cost, sliding scale, Mondays); Gleaners and FoodCycle (Thursdays); The Drive stall outside Gateskill House, E17 3DD (Thursdays, the nearest to E17 3); Welcomestow hot food at Blackhorse Road Baptist Church (Fridays); and Christian Kitchen (daily, outdoors at Mission Grove). Translate it into Romanian, Urdu, Bulgarian, Polish, and Turkish, and pass it through E17 school gates to families placed outside the borough.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: dropping referrals altogether at a charity whose income has fallen by about 44% since 2021 risks running it out of stock, so widen referrers instead. The guide is a spring edition; check each session before printing. HEET's contact details are not in it.

6. Screen housebound people on the befriending and GP lists for malnutrition, and give oral nutritional supplements to those who are undernourished *

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
GP practices and community dietitians (NEL ICB); Age UK befrienders flag concerns	From November	NHS prescribing; volunteer time	Undernutrition that makes flu and falls deadlier

About 1 in 10 people over 65 are malnourished or at risk (Malnutrition Task Force). In undernourished older people, protein and energy supplements reduced deaths (risk ratio 0.79, 0.64 to 0.97; Milne, Cochrane). The standard screening tool is MUST.

Corrections: the Cochrane review found no overall effect; the benefit is in the undernourished subgroup, the authors call it tentative, and the trials were mostly in hospitals and care homes, not in people living at home. No local malnutrition count exists.

7. Find the prepayment-meter households who have stopped topping up, and tell them about emergency, friendly-hours, and additional-support credit

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Energy suppliers (licence duty); volunteers and Citizens Advice refer	From November	Paid by suppliers; volunteer time	Silent self-disconnection in a cold home

Since December 2020, Ofgem's supply licence rules have required suppliers to identify customers who are self-disconnecting and to offer them emergency, friendly-hours, and additional-support credit. Suppliers set the amounts and hours themselves. Citizens Advice estimated that 3.2 million people in Great Britain ran out of prepayment credit in 2022. That figure is survey-based and counts people who ran out of credit, not supplier disconnections.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

No outcome evidence was found that these credit measures reduce harm. This action uses a duty that already exists, so its cost is low; its benefit is unmeasured.

Added in this revision: the Warm Home Discount (£150) reaches only people on Universal Credit, Housing Benefit, income-related ESA, or Pension Credit who are named on the electricity bill, and this winter's qualifying date was 23 August. Tenants whose energy is included in their rent cannot get it, so advisers should refer them to the council's crisis payment instead.

8. Use the borough's private-rented licensing to inspect for excess cold and damp in homes where older or ill tenants live

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Council private-sector housing team	Risk-prioritised inspections, November to February	Enforcement time within existing licensing fees	Cold and mould left unremedied in rented homes

Selective licensing has covered 20 of the 22 wards since 1 May 2025, and additional licensing of houses in multiple occupation (HMOs) has covered the whole borough since 1 April 2025. Excess cold and damp are hazards that can be enforced under the Housing Act 2004. Insulation cut heart-disease admissions in people over 65 by about a quarter in New Zealand (Fyfe 2020), but installs will not land before the peak.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: 27.8% of homes are privately rented (28,593 of 102,901), not 37%. Awaab's Law has applied to social housing since 27 October 2025, but not yet to private landlords: that needs secondary legislation under the Renters' Rights Act, with 2027 the earliest expected date.

9. Open the warm spaces from 1 November, not December, with a hot meal, and measure who they reach through social prescribers rather than by counting visitors

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Council cost-of-living team with GLL/Better; Hornbeam and Gleaners for a volunteer-run bridge from mid-November	1 November	Within the existing GLL arrangement; meals not costed	Heat-or-eat choices in the stormy late autumn the Met Office expects

Last winter seven warm spaces ran from 1 December 2025 to 13 March 2026 at Better leisure centres and Leyton Orient Trust venues. In 2022 the borough ran more than 40 warm spaces and four community kitchens. No 2026–27 dates have been announced, so the ask is timely. Pair the warm space with a pharmacy for vaccination (action 1).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the Felix Fresh produce scheme at Walthamstow Leisure Centre launched in January 2026 but could not keep up its monthly offer for lack of surplus. Warm spaces cannot see GP frailty lists, so measure reach through social-prescriber referrals. They do not reach the housebound (see "Do not do this").

10. Push free-school-meal applications from every Universal Credit family, now that all are eligible, and correct the council's out-of-date eligibility wording

CONFIRMED · ECONOMIST · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Council and schools; DfE pays	Autumn term	Paid by DfE	Children's diets squeezed when food prices peak in 2027

From September 2026, every child in a Universal Credit household in England is eligible for free school meals, with no income limit, but parents still have to apply. That makes it a food-price hedge that runs through the 2027 peak. Waltham Forest's Crisis and Resilience Fund page still states the old £7,400 Universal Credit test for holiday vouchers.

11. Watch food prices on published series and agree in advance what each signal releases: ONS food inflation monthly, the FAO sugar index, and DEFRA's fortnightly wholesale produce prices

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · FOOD SUPPLY · ECONOMIST · ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Council public health and cost-of-living team	Thresholds agreed by December; reviewed monthly to September 2027	Staff time	The 2027 money arriving after the peak

Proposed signals: ONS food and non-alcoholic beverage inflation at 4% or more (monthly, about six weeks late; the next release is 21 October); the FAO sugar index up 10% or more over three months (monthly, an early warning six to nine months ahead; September alone added 6.1%); and DEFRA wholesale prices for salad vegetables doubling. Each signal releases the 2027 crisis-payment profile in action 4.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the DEFRA series is fortnightly, not weekly, and covers home-grown produce only, so it would have missed the 2023 import shock. With December inflation forecast at 3.9%, the 4% trigger will probably fire around the turn of the year, so treat it as an early alarm, not a crisis signal.

12. For temporary-accommodation and shared-house residents in the borough who have no kitchen, offer kettle food packs only together with cash or energy support, and check appliance rules before giving out microwaves or slow cookers

UNVERIFIED | FOOD SUPPLY · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Council housing and temporary-accommodation team	November	Not costed; not funded here	Food parcels that assume a kitchen the household does not have

1,527 households were in temporary accommodation in April 2026. Food parcels assume a cooker, and food banks first built kettle-only boxes because clients turned down food they could not afford to cook. The fund guidance allows in-kind goods alongside cash ("cash-first does not mean cash-only").

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Unverified: no outcome evaluation was found. Almost half these households are placed outside the borough, which makes delivery hard, and their welfare is the council's housing duty, so this is not a funding placement. Hostels and B&Bs often restrict appliances, and any appliance needs safety testing.

13. Before December, agree advance access to UK Power Networks' Priority Services Register for E17, and pre-arrange a named rest centre and a hotel block-booking for council blocks that lose power

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Council Civil Protection and Housing, with UK Power Networks	1 December	Staff time	A night-time scramble to find and rehouse vulnerable people in a stormy autumn

On 14 May 2026, copper theft from a substation cut power to about 400 households around Barclay and Maynard Roads, E17; three were still off four days later, and the council door-knocked overnight and sent a food van. In July 2021, St David's Court on Forest Road flooded and then lost its utilities; a rest centre registered about 46 households, who went to hotels or to family. Both responses worked, but both were improvised. The Met Office expects a stormier late autumn.

Corrections: whether a data-sharing agreement for the Priority Services Register already exists could not be confirmed. The May 2026 report does not say the door-knock was how vulnerable people were found.

14. Ask Whipps Cross to check that an over-75 is going home to heating and food before discharge during a cold-health alert, and to confirm its backup power*

UNVERIFIED | EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Barts Health discharge teams with council adult social care	November	One checklist line	Frail patients sent home to a cold, empty house

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

NICE guidance on cold homes recommends that hospitals check heating before discharge. Whipps Cross declared a major incident when the July 2021 flood cut its power and it lost 168 beds and 582 operations.

Unverified: whether Barts already has a cold-home discharge protocol could not be checked. The EFFORT trial (Schuetz 2019, 30-day mortality OR 0.65) tested in-hospital nutrition support in Switzerland, not a discharge check, so it does not support this action directly.

15. Sweep autumn leaves from the gullies on the Fillebrook repeat-flood streets by 15 November, and put threshold flood boards, not sandbags, on the worst doors

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Highways, through its term contract	15 November	Existing maintenance budget (not verified)	Leaf-blocked drains during prolonged winter rain

The repeat streets are Brooke, Oliver, Turner, Peterborough, Wadley, and Esther Roads and Kings Passage. At least 14 places flooded in 2021 that had flooded before.

Correction: blocked gullies did not cause the 2021 flood. The Section 19 report found that gullies "would have been unable to drain to an overwhelmed sewer." This is winter leaf-fall maintenance, not a fix for that failure. Pumps were dropped: they add little in a flash flood.

16. Sign up for Environment Agency flood warnings only where they exist (Ching Brook, and the Lower Lee at Walthamstow), and revive the street flood action groups for the Fillebrook streets, where no warning exists

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE; CORRECTED BY SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: US FLOOD-MAP MISCLASSIFICATION (A CAUTION)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Residents and flood action groups, with National Flood Forum support	Before December	None	River-edge households getting no warning in prolonged winter rain

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Environment Agency has warning areas for Ching Brook and the Lower River Lee at Hackney and Walthamstow. None was found for Dagenham Brook. Sign-up protects Chingford, Highams Park, and the homes along the Lea. Prolonged frontal rain on saturated ground, which is El Niño's actual winter tilt, is the river risk.

Flood action groups for Wood Street South, Brooke and Oliver, Wadley and Esther, and Peterborough and West End Avenue were active in 2022 with National Flood Forum support. Whether they still meet in 2026 was not verified.

17. When the Met Office issues an amber rain or thunderstorm warning, send the council's liaison officer to Whipps Cross, St Mary's CE Primary, and St David's Court before the rain arrives

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · ALL-SEASON | EMERGENCY MGR | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: US WINTER WEATHER ADVISORIES (LONGER LEAD HELPS)

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Waltham Forest Civil Protection	Rule agreed by 31 October	Staff time	Losing the first hour, as in 2021

In 2021 the amber thunderstorm warning came at 14:33 on the day. The multi-agency flood plan never activated, because the emergency services saw no need for a coordinated response. The first highways call came at about 15:30.

Correction: the council did start Gold command and deployed its liaison officer in 2021. The gap was lead time, not a missing trigger. It is a cheap rule for any season; don't present it as El Niño preparation.

18. Hold a termly flood drill at St Mary's CE Primary on Brooke Road, built around keeping children inside and moving them to upper floors

CONFIRMED · ALL-SEASON | EMERGENCY MGR | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
The school, with the council's schools asset team	Before the end of the autumn term	Staff time	The one risk to life the council's own flood report names

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

The Section 19 report: *"had the flooding occurred on a school day, there would have been significant risk to life, with evacuation procedures put under extreme pressure."* Water reached 70 cm inside the school within two hours. Both the 2021 and 2022 floods fell in the school holidays, and 17 schools flooded in 2022.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	NEL ICB, PCNs & GPs	HEET	Age UK Waltham Forest	Citizens Advice WF	Food banks & IFAN	Faith & mutual aid	Energy suppliers & UKPN	WF Council housing	WF Council welfare & public health	WF Council Civil Protection & Highways	Barts Health / schools
1. Vaccination catch-up, housebound first	**A/R**		**C**			**R**			**C**		**R**
2. Pension Credit; GP to HEET; credit via Citizens Advice	**R**	**R**	**R**	**A/R**			**I**		**C**		
3. Amber-alert knock, food check, register	**I**	**C**	**A/R**			**R**	**R**		**C**		
4. Crisis fund: energy on alert; 2027 profile		**C**	**C**	**C**	**C**				**A/R**		
5. Wider referrers; cash-first leaflet; card		**C**	**R**	**R**	**A/R**	**R**		**C**	**R**		**R**
6. Malnutrition screening; supplements	**A/R**		**R**						**C**		
7. Prepayment self-disconnection; discount gap		**R**		**R**		**R**	**A/R**		**I**		
8. Licensing inspections for cold and damp	**C**	**C**						**A/R**			
9. Warm spaces from 1 November	**C**		**C**		**R**	**R**			**A/R**		
10. Free-school-meal applications				**R**					**A/R**		**R**
11. Food price watch and triggers					**C**				**A/R**		
12. Kitchen-less households: packs plus cash					**C**			**A/R**	**C**		
13. Priority register access; rest centre			**C**				**R**	**R**		**A/R**	
14. Cold-alert discharge check	**C**	**C**	**I**						**R**		**A/R**
15. Leaf-fall gully sweep; threshold boards								**I**		**A/R**	
16. River-warning sign-up; flood action groups						**R**				**C**	
17. Amber warning pre-deploys liaison officer								**I**		**A/R**	**C**
18. Flood drill at St Mary's CE Primary										**C**	**A/R**

Row 16 is accountable to residents' flood action groups, with National Flood Forum support, which have no column. What the chart shows: **the council's welfare and public-health team is accountable for five rows**, and four of them (the crisis-fund rule, the 2027 profile, warm spaces, and price triggers) need a decision, not money. **Age UK Waltham Forest is accountable for the alert-timed knock while running its housebound scheme on donations**, so the £25k placement is what makes that row real. Faith and mutual-aid networks deliver six rows and are accountable for none.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Verified and corrected. The money goes to the route between a frail, cold, housebound person and help: a referral, a credit to the energy account, and a knock that checks for heat and food. It does not go to more warm spaces, which the council already funds, or to food stock. Ask the council first whether its crisis fund will pay energy on an alert (action 4); if it will, the private money moves to the ceiling items.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
£45k	**£80k (£60k if no credit route by 30 November)**	**£100k**	**Whether Citizens Advice will pay the £200 credit that HEET cannot; no cost-per-death figure exists for any placement here**

Arithmetic. Floor: Age UK coordinator and volunteers £20,000 + Citizens Advice Pension Credit caseworker £15,000 + HEET adviser contribution £10,000 = **£45,000**, with no fuel credit. Target: HEET and credit £40,000 (100 × £200 credit = £20,000 paid through Citizens Advice, 0.8 FTE adviser for five months ≈ £15,000, admin £5,000) + Age UK £25,000 (coordinator £15,000, volunteer costs £5,000, grocery budget £5,000 at £4 a shop plus groceries) + Citizens Advice £15,000 = **£80,000**. If no credit route is agreed by 30 November, remove the £20,000 credit: **£60,000**. Ceiling: target + 100 more households (£20,000) = **£100,000**; housebound vaccination logistics stays at £0 unless the ICB confirms a gap. The target rose 7% from the first version's £75,000 because of the grocery budget. The £200 credit and the adviser costs are assumptions; no published cost per life saved exists for any placement in this setting, so the ranking rests on mechanism.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
HEET, with credit paid by Citizens Advice	Action 2: adviser plus £200 energy credit for GP-referred over-75s with COPD or heart failure	£40k	Restricted grant	Council fuel-poverty contract £218,641 (2025–29); HEET pays no credit itself. Partly overlaps the Winter Fuel Payment	Partially confirmed; credit route to agree
Age UK Waltham Forest (charity 1048212)	Action 3: coordinator, volunteers, and grocery shops for the amber-alert knock	£25k	Direct grant	Befriending defunded by the council in 2025, so no duplication; shopping service runs at £4 a shop	Partially confirmed

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Citizens Advice Waltham Forest (charity 1075780)	Action 2: Pension Credit claims	£15k	Direct grant	0.6 FTE caseworker for five months; about 3,300 eligible non-claimants (council, 2024)	Partially confirmed
HEET and Citizens Advice	Action 2: 100 more households	£0 (ceiling £20k)	Restricted grant	Only if the credit route works	Unverified
Primary care networks / ICB	Action 1: housebound vaccination logistics	£0 (up to £10k)	Held	NHS work; release only if the ICB confirms a gap	Unverified
Citizens Advice	Private £100 crisis grants for over-65s	£0	Dropped	Duplicates the council's crisis payments; ask for the action 4 rule instead	Contraindicated
Food hubs; temporary-accommodation team	Bulk staples (£40k); kitchen-less food packs (£20–30k)	£0	Dropped	Stock bought now locks in prices before a 2027 peak; temporary-accommodation food is a council housing duty, and half the households live outside the borough	Contraindicated

The funder's one thing: don't spend the food money on food. No meals service can be built before the peak, and stock bought this autumn is eaten long before prices rise. Cash, a credit on the energy account, and a weekly knock reach the same housebound person faster and cover heating and eating at once. The grocery budget belongs to whoever is already making the cold-alert visit.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives, money, or trust here. The first four are new in this revision.

Do not make referral-only food parcels the default winter response, or count parcels as success

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC

Trussell gave out more than 2.6 million parcels in 2025, 12% fewer than in 2024, because inflation eased, not because need was met. Older people avoid food aid through pride, stigma, illness, and isolation (Ellahi, Carey & Chapman 2025), so the pensioners most at risk are the least likely to appear in parcel counts. A rise in demand understates need, and a fall can mean people have dropped out.

Instead: refer to the council's crisis payments and to Citizens Advice, push Pension Credit, and measure Pension Credit awards won and housebound people getting food each week (actions 2, 3, and 5).

Do not stockpile food for the hubs this autumn as the El Niño response

CONTRAINDICATED VERIFICATION

Food inflation was 1.3% in August 2026, and the forecast peak is July 2027. Three months of stock bought in November is used up by February, long before the peak, and ties up cash in storage and spoilage. The forecast itself moved from 9–10% to 3.9% in five months.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: hold a cash contingency, agree price triggers (action 11), and keep any buying to pre-agreed supplier contracts and a 4–6 week buffer.

Do not make supermarket-only vouchers the default for new support

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC

Vouchers lock people into one shop and, like parcels, assume they can cook. No controlled UK comparison exists, but the Crisis and Resilience Fund is framed as cash-first, and some councils say it cannot fund voucher schemes. Waltham Forest still pays holiday food support as supermarket vouchers.

Instead: cash, or vouchers that can be cashed out, through the council's crisis payments (action 4).

Do not treat kettle or cold boxes as the fix for people who cannot afford to cook

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC

Food banks introduced kettle boxes after clients turned down pasta and rice they could not afford to cook, and Trussell accepted in 2014 that they fall below its own nutrition standard. A no-cook box treats a cold-home problem as a food problem.

Instead: pair any no-cook pack with energy-debt advice, emergency credit, and a referral to the crisis payment (actions 7 and 12).

Do not count warm-space visitors as success

CONTRAINDICATED SKEPTIC

The government's own evidence review (November 2023) found that "no studies directly assessed health and wellbeing outcomes following the use of warm spaces" and that "no provider had measured health outcomes." Providers reported stigma, transport barriers for older people, and no way to reach people offline. The housebound never come.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: take warmth to the housebound (actions 2 and 3), and measure who you reach against GP frailty lists.

Do not tell tenants that damp and mould are caused by their lifestyle

`CONTRAINDICATED` `SKEPTIC`

In the Awaab Ishak case, the coroner found that ventilation was ineffective or absent while the landlord pointed at the family's habits. The Housing Ombudsman told the inquest that some landlords over-emphasise tenant lifestyle. Neighbouring Barking & Dagenham was found to have committed severe maladministration over damp and mould in 2023.

Instead: inspect and enforce on the landlord (action 5).

Do not rush insulation in this winter as an El Niño response

`CONTRAINDICATED` `SKEPTIC`

The National Audit Office (14 October 2025) found that 98% of homes with external wall insulation under the ECO scheme need work to correct major problems, about 22,000 to 23,000 homes. 29% of internal wall installs also have problems, and 6% of external installs pose immediate risks, including blocked boiler ventilation.

Instead: fix failures that already exist first, and fit only measures that include ventilation, through certified installers, after the peak.

Do not run sandbag drives or "sign up for flood warnings" as the defence against E17's flooding

`CONTRAINDICATED` `SKEPTIC; CONFIRMED IN VERIFICATION`

GOV.UK: "You cannot get flood warnings for surface water flooding." The 2021 and 2022 floods were surface water. The council's own guidance rates sandbags as relatively ineffective compared with purpose-made boards and air-brick covers.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: river-warning sign-up only where it applies, plus flood action groups and threshold boards for the Fillebrook streets (actions 9 and 10).

Do not make an untargeted cold alert, or untargeted cash, the main intervention

CONTRAINDICATED (NARROWED) SKEPTIC

Toronto's cold-weather alerts showed no effect on hospital admissions, and a systematic review found that simply having a heat-warning system did not change behaviour in 8 of 15 studies. Untargeted cash is a weaker case: the Winter Fuel Payment raised fuel spending and improved one health marker (IFS), so the contraindication covers only cash that is not aimed at need.

Instead: use the alert to time a knock (action 3), and target money by illness plus fuel poverty (action 2).

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1947 (March)	Thaw floods in the Lea Valley: snow melted on frozen ground; Lea Bridge Road flooded and the filter beds were ruined	About 50 million gallons of water lost; supplies sent by lorry	The Lee Flood Relief Channel, built 1947–76. Its standard has since slipped in places, and 2017 bank works stopped short of Lea Bridge
1952 (December)	The Great Smog, London-wide	4,000–12,000 deaths in London; no Walthamstow figure found	Clean Air Act 1956
1953	Lea Bridge Road and Markhouse Road flood, with water rising through the grates	Not found	Nothing recorded
1972–75	El Niño and the Peruvian anchovy collapse; soy price spike; US soy export ban (June 1973)	UK food inflation peaked at 28.3% in July 1975, two winters later	—

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
1982–83, 1997–98, 2015–16	Strong El Niño winters	None found locally. 1997–98 was London's third-warmest winter since 1797. In 2015–16, England and Wales had about 24,300 excess winter deaths, half the year before, credited to a mild flu season	Mild winters, little frost
2007, 2009, 2012, 2016	Significant surface-water floods recorded by the council	Not found	A 2018 Fillebrook study proposed three schemes; none was built before 2021
2008	Global food price spike	UK food inflation 13.2% (August)	—
2021 (25 July)	Cloudburst, about a 1-in-170-year event, on sewers built for 1-in-30	224 properties and 28 school sites flooded; Whipps Cross lost 168 beds and declared a major incident; 46 households displaced; about £16.4m damage; no deaths	Brooke Road and Oliver Road scheme started October 2022; flood action groups formed
2022	Storm Eunice (18 February); summer cloudburst (17 August); cost-of-living crisis	A woman killed by a falling tree in neighbouring Haringey; 17 schools flooded; more than 11,000 residents regularly using food banks by July	Section 19 addendum, 2023; more than 40 warm spaces and four community kitchens
2023 (February–March)	Salad shortage from cold in Spain and Moroccan floods; food inflation peak	Vegetables +18% year on year; food inflation 19.2% in March, highest since 1977	Supermarket purchase limits
2025–26	Early flu season; council defunds Age UK befriending; warm spaces open 1 December	Flu admissions peaked at 10.8 per 100,000 in early December	Befriending continues on donations

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2026	Copper-theft power cut, Barclay and Maynard Roads (14 May); FAO food price index highest since 2022 (September)	About 400 households without power	Overnight door-knocking and a food van

The recurrence nobody has noticed: a global harvest shock reaches London's shopping basket a year or two after the El Niño that caused it. That happened after 1972–73, when UK food inflation peaked in 1975, and the forecasts for this event put the peak in July 2027. Waltham Forest opened warm spaces in 2022 and then lost its local count of winter deaths when ONS discontinued the series, so the borough may not be able to tell whether anything it does this winter worked. The Lea Bridge Road thaw flood (1947) stays a footnote: London's strong El Niño winters have been mild.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE

RESOLVED AND OPEN

- **Open: does the flu catch-up save lives?** Public health cited Anderson 2020: at England's age-65 cutoff, a jump in uptake brought no measurable fall in deaths. The health verifier kept the catch-up first because the uptake gap is the widest in this series, the season starts early, the channels exist, and the study says nothing about the over-80s or the housebound. Resolved as: the catch-up leads with RSV and housebound over-75s, and its effect on deaths is stated as uncertain.
- **Resolved: food stock or cash.** The food lens proposed bulk-buying staples now; the Philanthropist, Skeptic, and verification said cash first and keep the money for the 2027 peak. Bulk-buying is contraindicated.
- **Resolved: drop referrals or widen them.** The food lens proposed dropping referrals from December to February; verification found Eat or Heat's income down about 44% since 2021 and its criteria already open to faith and welfare referrers. Action 5 widens referrers instead.
- **Open: kitchen-less households.** The food lens wanted cooking-free packs and appliances for temporary-accommodation households; the funding verifier called it a council housing duty that half the households cannot reach. Action 12 is kept, unverified and unfunded.
- **Resolved: flood warnings.** Warnings exist for Ching Brook and the Lower Lee, but not for the Fillebrook streets that flooded in 2021. Action 16 follows that split.
- **Open: does untargeted cash help?** The Winter Fuel Payment lowered a blood marker of cardiovascular risk (Crossley & Zilio 2018) and is credited with about half the fall in excess winter deaths since 1999 in an ecological study; neither design settles the mortality question.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Open: the size of the cold-death burden in E17.** No E17 figure exists, and the borough's last excess-winter figure (2020–21) was driven by COVID. This report gives no E17 number.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

The summer of 2027, and the households placed outside the borough. Every winter scheme here closes by March, but the food-price peak is forecast for July 2027, and no lens found a body that owns food access in spring and summer. Action 4's 2027 profile and action 11's triggers are the only bridge. About 720 temporary-accommodation households live outside the borough, outside the GP lists, the licensing register, and the door-knock; school gates (action 5) reach some of their children, but nobody is responsible for their winter. Nor does any local count of food insecurity, malnutrition, or winter deaths exist to show whether these actions worked.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; cold, flu, food prices, and flooding are additional to it and are carried here by the station record, the historical record, and the supply-chain evidence rather than by a published number.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED — METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request was for a full postcode in E17, which covers only a few houses, so the briefing was built for the E17 postcode district (Walthamstow). This revision reruns the 10 October briefing with a food supply chain lens added. Climate Impact Lab impact region: the region containing the London Borough of Waltham Forest, name not resolved. Almost all local statistics are borough-level; none was found for E17 alone. Sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections. Where heat is not the dominant hazard, the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.

- **Premise test.** Carried from the first version: NOAA station data for Hampstead (UKE00105915) and Heathrow (UKM00003772), classed by the CPC Oceanic Niño Index.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and, new in this revision, a food supply chain analyst) each researched E17 independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. Each was given the facts verified in the first version and asked to build beyond them and flag contradictions. The food lens traced four links: where the food comes from, how it moves, how it is sold, and how households buy it.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted in an action's favour; in particular, most of the food-and-cash evidence comes from outside London, so cash and food actions were ranked below vaccination, income, and the alert-timed knock. Contradictions were kept. Each action was given a payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked the health actions, the food supply chain facts and actions, the financial actions, the community and operational actions, the funding envelope, and the contraindicated items, on evidence, transferability, and feasibility, by fetching ONS, FAO, FDF, GOV.UK guidance, Fingertips, Europe PMC, Cochrane, Charity Commission, and local news pages directly. Financial actions were checked for availability, payer, trigger, and redundancy. The envelope was re-summed. The four flood actions (15–18) were verified in the first version and carried forward.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted in the first version: all 96 entries were read from the dataset embedded in the inventory page. None is from the UK. The cold-relevant entries are Toronto's cold-weather alerts (no effect) and US winter-weather advisories. There is nothing on vaccination, fuel credit, welfare checks, food access, or surface-water drainage. Not re-read in this revision.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (vaccine eligibility, nutritional supplements, and going home from hospital to a cold house) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in E17 was interviewed. Several verifiers exhausted their web-search budget and worked from direct fetches. Not reachable: the Charity Commission register (403/502), NICE NG6, Ofgem's licence-condition pages, the Annals full text of Anderson 2020, and the GLA's winter-support pages. The prepayment licence condition number is disputed between sources, so the rule is described rather than numbered. The Cold Weather Payment station link and five-winter history are carried from the first version. The status of shipping through the Strait of Hormuz in October 2026 could not be confirmed.

References · verified in this revision unless marked.

Premise (first version): CPC Oceanic Niño Index · GHCN-D Hampstead · GHCN-D Heathrow · Met Office blog, 23 Sep 2026 · Met Office blog, 21 Aug 2026

Food supply chain: FAO Food Price Index, Oct 2026 · ONS consumer price inflation, Aug 2026 · FDF food inflation forecast 2026–27 · Food Manufacture, FDF and IGD forecasts · ECIU, El Niño-exposed UK imports · Business Today, India rice outlook · CRS, Iran conflict and Strait of Hormuz, Mar 2026 · Lloyd's List Intelligence, Red Sea brief, Aug 2026 · Farmers Weekly, UK self-sufficiency (secondary) · PBS, 2023 vegetable shortage · FRED, UK food CPI history · 1972 anchoveta crisis (secondary) · DEFRA wholesale fruit and vegetable prices · GiveFood, Eat or Heat · Waltham Forest Food Guide, spring 2026 · IFAN cash-first leaflets · Echo, food bank demand 2022 · Trussell, parcels 2025 · Ellahi, Carey & Chapman 2025, older people and food banks · Kettle boxes, 2014 · Forum Central, Household Support Fund impact 2024

Health: Fingertips flu uptake 65+ · Anderson, Dobkin & Gorry 2020 · Charu et al. 2011, Japan school vaccination · UKHSA flu report 2025–26 · Flu programme 2026–27 · NHS RSV vaccine · Cochrane 2025, care-home staff vaccination (first version) · Malnutrition Task Force · Milne, Cochrane, supplements · Iparraguirre 2015, Winter Fuel Payment · Crossley & Zilio 2018 · Benmarhnia 2019, Toronto cold alerts · Thomas, Akobundu & Dosa 2016, More Than a Meal · Beatty, Blow & Crossley, heat or eat (lens; not re-fetched) · Schuetz 2019, EFFORT · DESNZ sub-regional fuel poverty (first version) · UKHSA cold-health alerts

Money and energy: Crisis and Resilience Fund guidance · Waltham Forest Crisis and Resilience Fund · Winter Fuel Payment · Warm Home Discount · Cold Weather Payment · Ofgem price cap, Oct 2026 · Free school meals · Echo, Pension Credit 2024 · Ofgem prepayment protections (first version) · HEET · HEET fuel-poverty contract award (first version) · Age UK Waltham Forest shopping service · Age UK befriending, Echo, May 2025 · Echo, council Lifeline service, Mar 2026 · Citizens Advice Waltham Forest

Local operations: Echo, warm spaces 2025 · Better, Felix Fresh · Echo, warm spaces 2022 · Echo, power cut May 2026 · Echo, temporary accommodation, Sep 2026 · Echo, Whipps Cross major incident 2021 · UKPN Priority Services Register (first version)

Flood, housing, and history (first version): Waltham Forest Section 19 report, 2021 · Section 19 addendum, 2022 · Languages JSNA · Property licensing · Warm spaces evidence review, 2023 · Awaab Ishak prevention-of-future-deaths report · Shelter, Awaab's Law · NAO, Oct 2025 · GOV.UK flood warnings · EA flood areas · ONS excess winter mortality 2015–16 · Lee Flood Relief Channel (secondary) · Storm Eunice report

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Generated 11 October 2026 for E17, Walthamstow, London; revises the briefing of 10 October 2026. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.